

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

OUTLINE

- Defining Oral Presentations
- Types
- Elements to consider
- Process of the presentations
- Seven Factors to remember

WHAT IS AN “ORAL PRESENTATION”?

- ⦿ The action of communication in which one speaker is doing most of the sending and a number of listeners are doing most of the receiving.

TYPES

1. Prepared/Extemporaneous
2. Reading or Manuscripts
3. Memorization
4. Impromptu

ELEMENTS

- ⦿ The Venue
- ⦿ The Organizers
- ⦿ The Occasion
- ⦿ The Time available
- ⦿ Other Speakers
- ⦿ The Audience

PROCESS

1. Planning
2. Preparing/Writing
3. Delivering/Completing

PLANNING

⦿ **Determine the Purpose**

- To inform
- To persuade or motivate
- To entertain

⦿ **Audience Analysis**

- Determine audience's size & composition
- Predict audience's probable reaction
- Estimate the audience's level of understanding

PREPARING/WRITING

- ◉ Main idea or content
- ◉ Limit your scope
- ◉ Select your approach
- ◉ Prepare an outline
- ◉ Develop your presentation
 - Introduction
 - Body
 - Conclusion

DELIVERING/COMPLETING

◉ Oral Delivery

- Volume
- Rate
- Vocal Quality
- Pronunciation

CONTD.

◉ Nonverbal Delivery

- Posture
- Movement
- Gestures
- Facial Expressions
- Appearance

SEVEN FACTORS TO REMEMBER!

1. The Start

- ⦿ Do not apologize
- ⦿ Be confident
- ⦿ Know the topic well

2. Audience Mood

- ◉ Be empathic with your audience's mood
- ◉ Watch your audience's body language; their facial expressions, glances exchanged, shuffling of feet etc.
- ◉ Project the right degree of formality
- ◉ Use good pace and drive
- ◉ Don't be arrogant - this will turn your audience against you
- ◉ Control your enthusiasm

3. Your Voice

- ◉ Be clearly audible
- ◉ Use a microphone if necessary
- ◉ Keep your head up
- ◉ Open your mouth wider than during normal speech
- ◉ Speak comparatively slow so the audience can digest what you are saying
- ◉ Keep right level of stress, accent, and speed of speaking
- ◉ Use a good pitch - the musical tone - vary it. High notes convey urgency, the low notes convey emphasis

4. Body Language

- ⦿ Positioning of your body - stand in a good posture, do not pace around too much
- ⦿ Use your hands in proper gestures to support your points
- ⦿ Good use of eye contact - gains and holds attention and establishes rapport
- ⦿ Avoid mannerisms that irritate, e.g. swaying side to side, fiddling with marker, fidgeting with fingers, swirling to and fro etc.
- ⦿ Avoid hands in pockets

5. Your Visual Aids

- ⦿ When using flip charts or white boards, write from the side
- ⦿ Write legibly
- ⦿ Stand so that you do not block the view of the screen
- ⦿ Do not speak to the board or screen

6. Timing

- ⦿ Make sure you end on time
- ⦿ Observe the division of time from the introduction to body and to the conclusion

7. Conclusion

- ◉ Finish with equal enthusiasm as was on start
- ◉ Ask the audience for action
- ◉ Leave no doubt in your audience's mind that you have come to an end of your presentation

LAST, BUT NOT THE LEAST

“There are no secrets to success. It is the result of preparation, hard work, and learning from failure.”

Gen. Colin L. Powell

SUGGESTED READINGS

- Adair, J. (2003). Adair on Communication and Presentation Skills. Thorogood: London. pp. 36-41
- Abhiyan, S. (2003). Module on *Communication Skills in English*. New Delhi: India. pp. 146-157

ANY QUESTIONS???

THANK YOU!